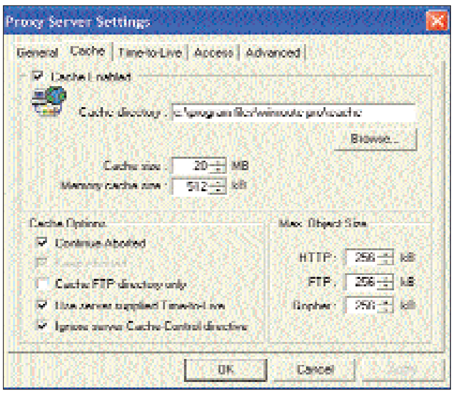
WinRoute Pro

WinRoute Pro (WRP) provides excellent NAT functionality, and it's a strong contender for the title of 'Most Secure Software' for people with an always on broadband connection.

System administrators would love the control they get over the dial-up connection. The connection can work on a demand-dial basis, or it can be persistent; it can also be manually operated. It could even be customised by time intervals.



WinRoute gives you full control over the parameters related to caching such as size, TTL, etc.

To restrict Internet use to be work-specific, you can set up the Web sites that are allowed by the management to be accessed by users. You can create groups and specify different sets of sites for each group.

The proxy server bundles along a full-fledged mail server module with anti-spam capabilities. The software allows for cache size and TTL to be specified separately for HTTP, FTP and Gopher. There's a history viewer as well as half a dozen different logs—Debug, Error, HTTP, Mail, Security and Dial log.

+ Lists of allowed sites, mail server
– No bandwidth management and monitoring

Price: NA
Web site: http://www.kerio.com/kerio.html

WinRoute Pro B

Performance	▶▶▶▶▷
Features	▶▶▶▶▷
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▷
Overall	▶▶▶▷▷

Info By default, proxy software binds itself to all the TCP/IP interfaces present on the machine. The disadvantage of this is that it will also service requests coming in from the Internet. This could lead to misuse. By forcing the proxy to bind to one of your local IP addresses, you can avoid undesirable side effects.

Inbuilt capabilities of Windows OSes

If you have Windows 2000 Server, you don't need proxy or gateway software: Windows 2000 has inbuilt support for Internet connection sharing.

By default, when you install Windows 2000 Server, the routing component is automatically installed. However, the Routing and Remote Access service is installed in a disabled state. To set it up, start Routing and Remote Access, right-click on the server and click 'Configure and Enable Routing and Remote Access'. Now, follow the wizard to set up Internet sharing. Open Routing and Remote Access by going to ***Start*** > ***Programs*** > ***Administrative Tools*** > ***Routing and Remote Access***.

If you want to set up just Internet sharing, with no routing, right-click on the connection, within dial-up networking, which is to be shared. On the Sharing tab, select the 'Enable Internet connection sharing for this connection' checkbox, and you're done!

Windows XP, too, provides ICS functionality, but the difference is that in Windows 2000, ICS will get enabled only on dial-up connections; so if you want to share the Internet connection on two IP addresses or two Ethernet cards, you'll need to set up a routing protocol, either IGMP or OSPF. But in XP, you can enable ICS on the Ethernet card, although you need at least two Ethernet cards, or alternatively, a pair of dial-up connections and an Ethernet card.

Additionally, Windows 2000 Server has integrated DNS, Telnet, FTP, SMTP, POP3 as well as DHCP servers, thus providing you with everything that you require to set up a small Internet server.